Table 5.3: Pigmentation of chromogenic bacteria

Bacteria	Pigment colour
Serratia marcescens	Red
Staphylococcus aureus	Golden yellow
Micrococcus luteus	Yellow
Pseudomonas aeruginosa	*Green*

fungi prefer to grow in the acidic medium. Sabourad Dextrose Agar (SDA) plates and Potato Agar plates are used for general cultivation of fungi. The acidic nature of SDA agar reduce the growth of bacteria.

The characters to be noticed in colony of fungi are colour of the surface and reverse of the colony, texture of the surface (powdery, granular, ecolly, cottony, velvety or glabrous), the topography (elevation, folding, margin) and the rate of growth.

Infobits

Dimorphic fungi are fungi that can exist in both mold and yeast form depending on environmental and physiological conditions. Example: *Histoplasma capsulatum,* a human pathogen, grows as a mold form at room temperature and as a yeast form at human body temperature.

- **Growth and colony characteristics of yeast *Candida***

  Yeasts are grown on Sabourad Dextrose Agar aerobically. Yeasts grow as typical pasty colonies and give out yeasty odour. The colony morphology varies with different yeasts. Yeasts colonies generally have smooth texture and are larger than bacterial colonies on SDA medium (Figure 5.16a).

- **Growth and Colony characteristics of mold *Mucor***

  The genus *Mucor* is typically coloured white to brown or grey and is fast growing. Older colonies become grey to brown due to the development of spores. (Figure 5.16b).



Figure 5.16: Fungal growth on Sabouraud Dextrose Agar media a) yeast growth b) mold growth

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